

Getting Here & Getting Around

Airports, railheads, road conditions, permits, transfers and parking. Distances and times are to the estate at Upper Syari, Gangtok.

Where We Are

The Glass Hotel, Upper Syari, Gangtok 737101, East Sikkim, India. The estate is about 2 km above MG Marg, roughly ten minutes by car, on the ridge road that climbs out of town towards Syari.

From	Distance	Typical time
MG Marg, central Gangtok	2 km	10 min by car
Bagdogra Airport (IXB)	~124 km	4–5 hours by road
Pakyong Airport (PYG)	~33 km	1 hour by road
New Jalpaiguri railhead (NJP)	~117 km	4–5 hours by road
Siliguri	~114 km	~4 hours by NH10
Darjeeling	~98 km	4 hours
Kalimpong	~75 km	3 hours

The short version

Almost everyone arrives by air into Bagdogra and drives up NH10 along the Teesta. It is a long, beautiful, occasionally slow drive, and it is the reason we tell guests to book a morning flight. Pakyong, Sikkim's own airport, is far closer but its schedule is thin and weather-dependent.

Give the driver 'Upper Syari, above the Syari football ground' if the estate name is unfamiliar — we are newer than most of the local landmarks.

By Air

Bagdogra (IXB) — the practical choice

The nearest full-service airport, with daily connections to Delhi, Kolkata, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Chennai and Guwahati. It is a small terminal and it congests; allow 90 minutes for departure formalities on the way home.

From Bagdogra the drive is 4–5 hours. **Take a morning flight.** The last stretch of NH10 and the ascent into Gangtok are best done in daylight, and a flight landing after 2:00 PM risks arriving in the dark.

Pakyong (PYG) — close, but check it flies

Sikkim's own airport, 33 km and about an hour away, at 4,500 ft on a ridge. Service has been intermittent since it opened and it closes in poor visibility, which in monsoon is often. If you can get a reliable flight, it saves four hours; do not build a tight plan around it.

Helicopter

A 30-minute Sikkim Government helicopter service runs between Bagdogra and Gangtok, about ₹4,000–₹5,000 per person, five seats, 15 kg baggage. It flies only in clear weather and is cancelled often. Treat it as a lucky upgrade, never as your plan — the helipad is at Burtuk, 15 minutes from us.

Transfers we arrange

Route	Vehicle	Price each way
Bagdogra to the estate	Private SUV, 4 guests	₹9,500
Pakyong to the estate	Private SUV	₹3,000
NJP to the estate	Private SUV	₹9,000
Helipad, Burtuk to the estate	Private car	₹1,200

By Rail and By Road

New Jalpaiguri (NJP)

The closest railhead, 117 km away, served by express trains from across India — the Darjeeling Mail from Kolkata and the Rajdhani from Delhi are the usual choices. From NJP it is the same 4–5 hour drive up NH10. Shared jeeps run from the taxi stand outside the station to Gangtok for ₹400–₹600 per seat, leaving when full, and private cabs cost ₹4,500–₹6,000.

Driving yourself from Siliguri

114 km, about four hours, on NH10 tracing the Teesta river. It is one of the great Indian drives and also a working highway with trucks, single-lane stretches and roadworks. Fuel at Rangpo, the last reliable pumps before the climb. Sikkim checkpost formalities at Rangpo take a few minutes; keep ID to hand.

- Drive the final ascent in daylight if you possibly can.
- Mountain rule: uphill traffic has right of way.
- Hire cars from Siliguri usually come with a driver, and for this road that is the sensible option.
- Motion sickness is common on the last two hours. Sit forward, and ask the driver to stop — they expect it.

Monsoon, landslides and winter

Between June and mid-September, NH10 can close for hours or occasionally a day after heavy rain, usually near Melli or Rangpo. The Border Roads Organisation clears quickly. Our concierge checks conditions each morning in monsoon and will message you before you set out. If the road is shut on your arrival day, our cancellation terms hold the full value of your booking as credit — see the house rules.

Snow does not fall in Gangtok itself in a normal winter. It falls above 3,000 m, which closes Nathula and sometimes Tsomgo between December and February.

Permits: What You Need and When

Sikkim needs no permit for Indian nationals. The permits below are for protected areas near the Chinese border, and the rules differ sharply for Indian and foreign passport holders.

Destination	Indian nationals	Foreign nationals
Gangtok, Rumtek, MG Marg	No permit	No permit
Tsomgo Lake, Baba Mandir	Inner Line Permit	Protected Area Permit, group of 2+
Nathula Pass	ILP, Wed–Sun only	Not permitted
North Sikkim, Lachung, Yumthang	ILP	PAP through a registered agency
Zuluk, Old Silk Route	ILP	PAP, group of 2+

What we need from you

- **Indian nationals:** a photo ID (Aadhaar, passport, licence or voter ID) and two passport photographs. One working day.
- **Foreign nationals:** passport, Indian visa, two photographs, and a registered agency to sponsor the permit — we appoint one. Two working days.
- Permit offices close on Sundays and public holidays. A Monday trip needs paperwork in by Saturday morning.
- Nathula permits are issued for Wednesday to Sunday only and are capped daily; in peak season they go quickly.

Permits are checked at the barrier and cannot be arranged on the day at the gate. Every year a few guests arrive hoping otherwise, and every year they are turned back at Kyongnosla.

Parking, Vehicles and Getting Around Town

Parking

Complimentary secure valet parking on the premises, staffed 24 hours, for eight cars. It is covered and inside the gate. Leave the key with the valet or keep it — either is fine; we do not insist. Vehicles are parked at owners' risk and we recommend leaving nothing visible inside.

EV charging

One 7.4 kW AC charger with a Type-2 socket, free to resident guests, first come first served. A full charge overnight is comfortable. There is no DC fast charging on the estate, and public charging in Sikkim remains sparse — arrive with enough range to reach Siliguri if you intend to leave on battery alone.

Cars and drivers

Service	Price	Notes
Town car, half day (4 hrs)	₹3,500	Within Gangtok
Town car, full day (8 hrs)	₹6,000	Within Gangtok
Tsomgo Lake and Baba Mandir	₹7,500	Full day, excludes permit
Nathula Pass, with Tsomgo	₹9,500	Full day, Wed–Sun, excludes permit
Rumtek Monastery	₹3,000	Half day
Airport drop, Bagdogra	₹9,500	Allow 5 hours plus check-in

On your own

Local taxis run from the stand at MG Marg; a ride into town is ₹250–₹400 and a shared seat is ₹30. There is no Uber or Ola in Gangtok. The town centre is pedestrianised, genuinely walkable, and steep — allow for the climb back. The Ropeway from Deorali to Tashiling is ₹120 and worth it for the view.